evacuate the building immediately.

The lifts are out of action, so we gingerly make our way down 12 flights of stairs and join the rest of the hotel guests who have assembled in the street. While they are dressed in pyjamas and dressing gowns, as you would expect at that hour, we are still wearing our T-shirts and jeans … and smiling inanely.

Nobody cared.

We had won a Test series in England for the first time since 1965, and neither defeat in the fourth Test at The Oval nor a 4–0 defeat in the ODI series that followed would remotely tarnish the memory.

Thursday, 27 November 2008

We are efficiently taking control of the second Test match against Bangladesh at Centurion, having won the first by an innings and 129 runs in Bloemfontein. Ashwell is batting brilliantly again, on his way to another big hundred, and I am making my way to the wicket with our score on 134 for four.

Shakib Al Hasan is bowling. I defend my first delivery and, next ball, advance down the wicket, but fail to make contact as the ball turns dramatically … and I'm stumped, out for nought. I am surprised. The ball hardly ever turns that much on the second day at SuperSport Park. Perhaps it hit a crack in the pitch.

As I make my way back towards the changing room, another thought strikes.

'Isn't that the first time I have been out for a duck in a Test match?' I wonder to myself.

It is. The records show I played 78 innings in Test matches before I failed to trouble the scorers on that quiet Thursday at Centurion Park. Aravinda de Silva, with 74, stands second on the all-time list of cricketers who have played the most Test innings before a duck, followed by Clive